Task – Hosting a Separate Promotional Campaign Website on the Same Server

Objective

The Marketing department required a separate website for a promotional campaign, to be hosted on the same Apache server as the existing website(s), without requiring a new server. This was achieved using Apache's Virtual Hosting feature to run an additional, independent website alongside the existing sites.

Requirements

- Existing AWS EC2 instance running RHEL with Apache already installed
- A dedicated folder for the promotional website's content
- A custom Virtual Host configuration file
- AWS Security Group configuration (already permitting port 80)
- Windows client machine for browser testing

Procedure

Step 1 – Create a Dedicated Folder for the Promotional Website

A new folder was created, separate from the existing website(s), to hold the promotional campaign's content:

```
sudo mkdir -p /var/www/zenhalpromo/html
```

Step 2 – Create the Promotional Webpage

An index.html file was created inside this new folder, styled as a marketing/campaign landing page:

```
sudo vi /var/www/zenhalpromo/html/index.html
```

The page included a campaign heading ("Special Promotion!"), a short promotional message, and a badge displaying the site's hostname.

Step 3 – Create a Custom Virtual Host Configuration File

A new Virtual Host configuration file was created to associate the promotional site's hostname with its dedicated document root:

sudo vi /etc/httpd/conf.d/zenhalpromo.conf

Configuration added:

```
<VirtualHost *:80>
   ServerName zenhalpromo.com
   DocumentRoot /var/www/zenhalpromo/html

   <Directory /var/www/zenhalpromo/html>
      AllowOverride All
      Require all granted
   </Directory>
</VirtualHost>
```

- ServerName defines the hostname this Virtual Host responds to.
- DocumentRoot points to the promotional site's dedicated folder, keeping its content completely separate from the existing website(s) on the same server.
- The Directory block grants Apache permission to serve files from this location.

Step 4 – Test and Apply the Configuration

sudo apachectl configtest

sudo systemctl reload httpd

The configuration test returned "Syntax OK," and Apache was reloaded to apply the new Virtual Host without affecting the existing website(s) already running on the server.

Step 5 – Map the Promotional Hostname Locally

Since zenhalpromo.com is not a registered public domain, it was mapped locally using the Windows hosts file:

C:\Windows\System32\drivers\etc\hosts

Entry added (edited as Administrator), using the same server IP already used for the existing site(s):

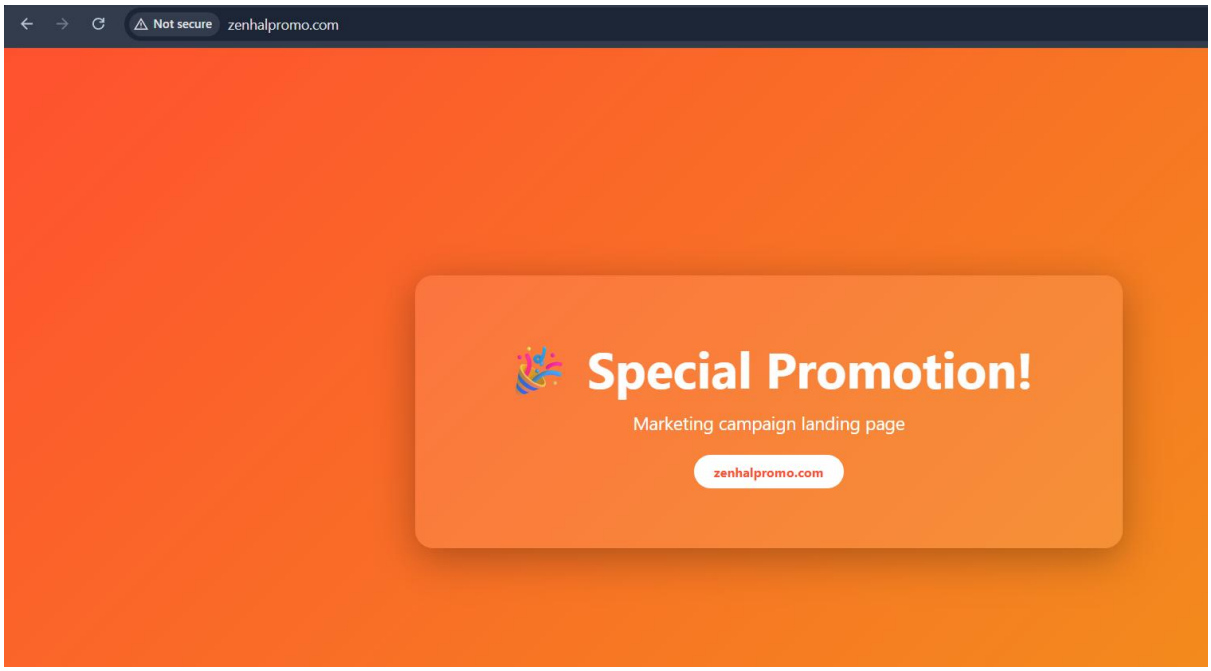
<EC2-Public-IP> zenhalpromo.com

Step 6 – Verification

The promotional website was accessed in a Windows browser:

http://zenhalpromo.com

The promotional campaign page loaded successfully, displaying its custom content and confirming it was being served independently from the existing website(s) on the same server.



Verification

- A dedicated folder was created for the promotional campaign website, separate from existing sites on the server.
- A custom Virtual Host configuration file was created, associating the hostname zenhalpromo.com with its own document root.
- The configuration was tested and applied without errors, without disrupting the existing website(s) already hosted on the server.
- The promotional website was successfully accessed using its custom hostname from a Windows browser.
- The existing website(s) on the server continued to function correctly alongside the new promotional site.

Conclusion

A separate promotional campaign website was successfully hosted on the same Apache server as the existing site(s), using Apache's Virtual Hosting capability. This avoided the need for a new server, while keeping the campaign site's content, folder structure, and configuration completely independent from the existing website(s). This task reinforced the practical value of Virtual Hosting for running multiple, distinct websites — including temporary or campaign-specific sites — on shared infrastructure.